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CPG EXECUTIVE BRIEF

From Reactive to Predictive

How CPG brands are replacing data latency with live retailer intelligence to protect shelf space and build AI-ready supply chains



95% On-Shelf Availability

Achieved by a leading DSD bakery brand across its entire retail footprint using live shelf data

Source: CPG Forum, Bentonville 2025

18hrs Stockout Lag Eliminated

Avg gap between empty shelf and corrective action, eliminated with live Delta Sharing connection

Source: CPG Forum, Bentonville 2025

10% Infra Cost Reduction

Documented by a global CPG enterprise that adopted Delta Sharing as a foundational data layer

Source: CPG Forum, Bentonville 2025

$2M+ Saved in 2 Years

By a single data platform after replacing SFTP-based partner data delivery entirely

Source: Kythera Labs, Databricks Blog, 2025

The Problem: Good Data Locked Behind Bad Infrastructure

Your retail partners hold the most operationally critical dataset in your business: live point-of-sale velocity, store-level inventory positions, promotional lift, and shopper behavior. They are willing to share it. The problem has never been access. It has been architecture.

The legacy collaboration model transforms a live operational signal into a delayed report. File-based exports arrive 48 to 72 hours after the fact. When a retailer corrects a historical record, your teams must detect the change, re-download affected files, and rerun ingestion pipelines from scratch. The consequences are measurable: $1.75 trillion in global retail out-of-stock losses each year, 20 to 30 percent of inventory value consumed by carrying costs, and 91 percent of shoppers unlikely to return after a single stockout experience. When your brand causes that stockout because it was working from stale data, the damage runs in every direction at once.

$1.75T Lost Annually

Global retail sales lost each year to out-of-stocks (8.3% of revenue)

Source: ToolsGroup, September 2024

91% Won't Come Back

Shoppers unlikely to return after experiencing a single stockout

Source: ToolsGroup, 2024

$1.75T Carrying Cost Burden

Of total inventory value consumed by holding costs every year

Source: NetSuite, E2open 2024-2025

What Delta Sharing Changes For Brand Teams

Delta Sharing is the world's first open protocol for cross-organization data collaboration, developed by Databricks. Rather than delivering data as files through proprietary APIs, Delta Sharing gives your teams direct live table access to retailer data in the tools you already operate: Databricks, Snowflake, Apache Spark, Python, Power BI, Tableau, and any Iceberg-compatible platform. When the retailer updates a record, the correction propagates automatically through Change Data Feed. No files to re-download. No pipelines to rerun.

The infrastructure cost reduction is documented and consistent. CPG organizations adopting Delta Sharing as a foundational data layer have reported approximately 10 percent reduction in infrastructure costs, driven by eliminating replication-related ETL compute, per-partner ingestion infrastructure, and engineering overhead from maintaining dozens of bespoke API integrations. A global e-commerce platform documented that brand partners were spending 1.5 full-time employees per month on manual data extraction alone. Delta Sharing eliminated that entirely.

10% Infrastructure Cost Reduction

Documented by CPG organizations adopting Delta Sharing as a data foundation

Source: CPG Forum, Bentonville 2025

80%+ Less Storage Required

After eliminating partner-by-partner data replication

Source: Kythera Labs, Databricks Blog, 2025

$645K Annual Egress Savings

By eliminating cross-cloud data replication costs

Source: Databricks, Allium case study, 2024

Customer Success Stories

SUCCESS STORY 1 | DIRECT STORE DELIVERY | CPG FORUM, BENTONVILLE 2025

How a Leading DSD Brand Achieved 95% On-Shelf Availability in a High-Volume Store

A leading bakery company operating more than 12,500 Direct Store Delivery routes faced a structural problem: route drivers arrived at stores without knowing what was actually needed. With no real-time shelf data, the process was entirely reactive. An empty shelf became a store manager complaint, which became an escalation, which became an analyst pulling a report from the prior day. By the time corrective action was taken, an average of 18 hours had passed and the revenue was already gone.

By connecting its operations to a live retailer data share powered by Delta Sharing on Databricks, the brand gained near-real-time visibility into stock levels across its entire retail footprint. Route planning became predictive. Drivers left distribution centers already knowing the exact shelf positions at every store on their route. Store managers stopped fielding complaints and started collaborating with field reps who had the same data they did. The 18-hour reactive loop was eliminated entirely.

The impact extended beyond individual routes. The same live shelf data that optimized route sequencing also informed promotional timing and category investment decisions. The same inventory signals that reduced stockouts fed insights directly into the retailer merchant relationship. One governed Delta Share. Multiple use cases. A field organization that went from reactive to predictive without building any new infrastructure on either side.

95%
On-shelf availability at retail

18 hrs
Stockout lag eliminated

12,500+
DSD routes now predictive

SUCCESS STORY 2 | GLOBAL CPG ENTERPRISE | CPG FORUM, BENTONVILLE 2025

How a Fortune 500 CPG Manufacturer Turned Delta Sharing Into a Platform and Prepared for Real-Time Demand Sensing at FIFA Scale

A global CPG enterprise with operations across dozens of markets made a strategic decision to treat Delta Sharing not as a data subscription but as a foundational data layer. Where other brands were using the live retailer connection as a reporting tool, this organization embedded it as the base on which its entire analytics and AI stack runs.

The operational results were measurable and consistent across five dimensions: compute and storage costs fell by approximately 10 percent, data management complexity dropped as automated Change Data Feed eliminated pipeline maintenance, engineering teams spent fewer hours on ingestion and more on insight, cross-market data collaboration accelerated, and data quality improved through automated monitoring and error detection.

The business case extended beyond cost. This organization is using the live data foundation to build real-time demand sensing ahead of FIFA 2026, a use case that requires continuous monitoring of inventory availability, store traffic, fulfillment performance, and demand signals across global markets simultaneously. During a major event, demand for certain categories can shift dramatically within hours. A batch data model cannot respond to this. A Delta Sharing foundation can. When the tournament begins, the capability to detect a demand spike the moment it forms, and act before the shelf empties, will already be operational.

~10%
Infrastructure cost reduction

5
Operational dimensions improved

FIFA 2026
Real-time demand sensing ready

Three Benefits That Compound Over Time

Supply Chain Precision	Live POS and inventory signals replace 48 to 72 hour stale exports. Route and replenishment planning shifts from reactive to predictive. Stockout detection compresses from days to real time.
Infrastructure Efficiency	One governed connection replaces dozens of bespoke API integrations. Change Data Feed auto-propagates corrections with no reruns required. CPG adopters have documented 10 percent infrastructure cost reduction.
AI-Ready Foundation	Live feeds power demand sensing and forecasting models in real time. Works across Databricks, Snowflake, Spark, Python, and leading BI tools. Foundation for agentic replenishment and autonomous supply chain workflows.

Delta Sharing is the future of retailer-brand collaboration. That was not a statement about technology. It was a statement about what changes when both sides of the relationship are working from the same live data at the same time.

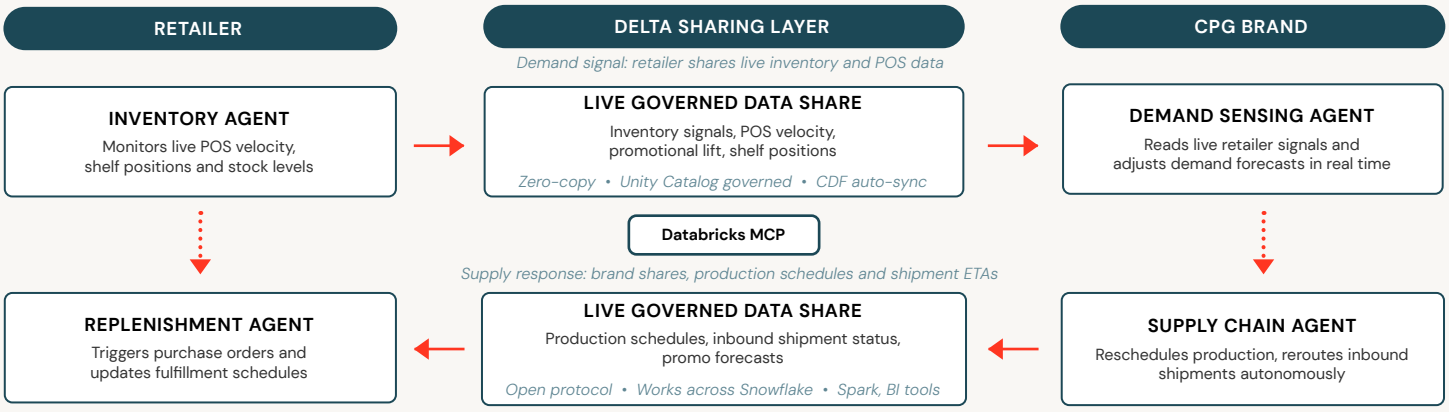
CPG Brand Executive | CPG Forum, Bentonville 2025

Looking Ahead: Agent-To-Agent Commerce

The CPG brands building live data infrastructure today are not only solving a supply chain problem. They are building the foundation for autonomous commerce. Gartner projects agentic AI in supply chain management will grow from less than $2 billion in 2025 to $53 billion by 2030, with 60 percent of enterprises having adopted agentic AI within their SCM workflows. The global agentic commerce market is projected to reach $3 to $5 trillion by 2030. (Gartner, April 2026)

In this near-term reality, a brand's demand-sensing agent and a retailer's inventory management agent communicate directly. The retailer agent detects a demand spike and shares the signal through a governed Delta Sharing connection. The brand agent adjusts its production schedule and reroutes inbound shipments automatically. Delta Sharing is the data protocol those agents read from. Databricks MCP is the communication layer they operate through.

AGENT-TO-AGENT COMMERCE: HOW DELTA SHARING CONNECTS THE LOOP



Both agents operate on live, governed data. No human in the loop. No file downloads. No pipeline delays. Delta Sharing is the data protocol. Databricks MCP is the agent communication layer. Unity Catalog enforces governance.

When the retailer's inventory agent detects a regional surge, it writes the updated inventory signal to a governed Delta Sharing table. The brand's demand-sensing agent reads it in real time and triggers the supply chain agent to reschedule production and reroute shipments. The brand agent then writes updated ETAs back through its own governed share, which the retailer's replenishment agent reads to confirm stock arrival. The loop that once took 18 hours closes in seconds without a human involved.

Databricks makes this architecture available today. Model Context Protocol (MCP) on Databricks connects AI agents to live data and tools through a standardized, governed interface built on Unity Catalog. Delta Sharing provides the cross-organization data layer those agents consume. The organizations that establish this foundation now will not just respond faster than competitors. Their agents will be the preferred counterparties in every automated trading relationship that follows.

Calculate Your Savings

Use the Databricks Delta Sharing Savings Calculator to estimate your infrastructure cost reduction, FTE recapture, and on-shelf availability revenue impact based on your retailer footprint and current data sharing method.

All benchmarks sourced from verified customer outcomes: 10% infrastructure cost reduction, 80% storage freed, 1.5 FTE recaptured per partner per month, $2M+ saved in 2 years.